

Making contaminant concentrations affect the ecosystem

- a very, very brief user guide -

Synopsis

With this new plug-in, which automatically nests itself as an external data set for Ecospace, users gain the ability to make per-species contaminant concentration maps available for driving the habitat foraging model and the other mortalities response system that is new in EwE 6.7.

Acknowledgements

<Stunning project logo to go here>

Usage

The setup process is a bit clunky, and involves the following steps:

Step 1: expose group contaminant concentrations

1. With Ecospace loaded, head over to Menu > Ecospace > Define External Data Connections. From the list of available data set templates, select “Ecotracer concentration dataset” and click “Create”;
2. In the form that pops up, select the group whose concentrations need exposing

Step 2: connect concentrations to an environmental driver

1. With Ecospace loaded, head over to Menu > Ecospace > Define Environmental Driver Maps and create an environmental driver for each contaminant concentration that you wish Ecospace to respond to. It would be sensible to give these drivers logical names such as “Concentration FG”;
2. Head over to Navigator > Ecospace > Input > External data, and connect any newly defined Ecotracer concentration dataset to drive the content of one of your newly defined environmental driver maps.

Step 3: apply an effect

1. In Navigator > Ecospace > Input > Ecospace environmental responses, define an environmental response function for each different contaminant concentrations response (either mortality or feeding capacity) that you wish to include;
2. In Navigator > Ecospace > Input > Ecospace environmental responses, under either “Apply foraging responses” or “Apply mortality responses”, connect a correct group, its contaminant concentration (contained in one of the environmental drivers) and appropriate response function.

Step 4: run the beast

1. Load Ecotracer and enable it for Ecospace
2. Run. It is particularly fun to watch the environmental drivers gain their content in the Run Ecospace form, maps view, environmental drivers option.